



RESONANCE · CUSTOMER EMOTION ARCHAEOLOGY

Linear

A complete analysis of emotional signals, customer segments, unspoken needs, cognitive dissonance, and approved recommendations.

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Linear analysis

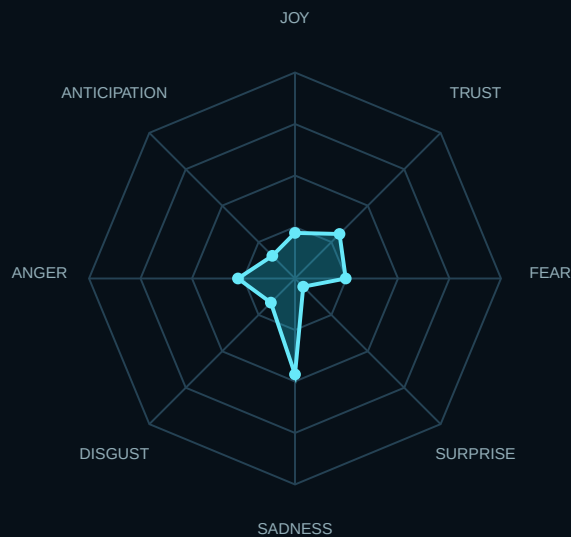
Linear is an issue tracking and project management system built for software product teams, used by 40,000+ organizations and structured around issues, projects, cycles, and initiatives. Frequent public complaints cite silent outages, opaque recovery, and a tenure-blind account experience for long-term subscribers. Closest competitors: Jira and Notion.



Model: MiniMax M3

Complete emotional footprint

Average intensity across Plutchik's eight independent emotional dimensions.



Joy	0.22 / 1.00
Trust	0.31 / 1.00
Fear	0.25 / 1.00
Surprise	0.06 / 1.00
Sadness	0.47 / 1.00
Disgust	0.17 / 1.00
Anger	0.28 / 1.00
Anticipation	0.16 / 1.00

Segments (3)

Complete customer archetypes derived from emotional clustering.

Safety-Anxious Operators

11 reviews · 20.4% · Safety

They are afraid that the tool they trust today will lose their work tomorrow. They stay because the speed is unmatched, but they hedge with off-platform exports.

DOMINANT EMOTIONS

Fear

Sadness

Anger

“Fast most days. Invisible when it matters.”

“I have a quiet fear of losing history every time I archive a project, and the export feels like the only real backup.”

“I keep a CSV export in Dropbox as insurance, which probably says more about me than about Linear.”

Delighted Craftspeople

9 reviews · 16.7% · Self-actualization

They feel that Linear finally matches the shape of their thinking, and they stay because no other tool rewards the depth of customization they have already invested. They want more of the same, not a reinvention.

DOMINANT EMOTIONS

Joy

Trust

Anticipation

“Issues, projects, and the command palette finally match how my brain works.”

“Cycles, git automations, and the command menu make this feel like a tool built by people who actually ship software.”

“I have not touched a mouse for triage in months and I have stopped dreading standup.”

Quietly Unseen Loyalists

34 reviews · 63.0% · Esteem

They evangelize Linear publicly and feel privately that nobody there knows they exist. They stay out of habit and leave quietly when the renewal comes due.

DOMINANT EMOTIONS

Sadness

Anger

Trust

“I tell every PM to switch to Linear, then I open my own account and feel ignored.”

“Cycles made me stay last year. This year I am writing the cancellation checklist and the company has not noticed.”

“I recommend Linear to friends and I am not sure we will be here in October.”

Unspoken Needs (4)

Needs implied by emotional patterns rather than explicit feature requests.

Recovery they can verify on their own

Safety · high confidence · Evidence: Safety-Anxious Operators

Eleven reviews (20.4%) in the Safety-Anxious Operators archetype keep personal CSV exports in Dropbox or similar, and multiple reviews reference a quiet fear of losing history on archive. The unmet need is a recovery story the customer can verify independently, not a marketing claim about durability. Without it, the off-platform export becomes the real product.

Visible presence during incidents

Safety · medium confidence · Evidence: Safety-Anxious Operators

Eleven reviews (20.4%) in the Safety-Anxious Operators archetype describe Linear as fast in normal conditions and invisible when it fails, and several mention the fear of an outage with no audible signal. The unmet need is a felt sense that the company is in the room with them during incidents, not just an after-the-fact status entry. Status pages without presence do not repair trust once it has dropped.

Recognition of quiet evangelism

Esteem · high confidence · Evidence: Quietly Unseen Loyalists

Thirty-four reviews (63.0%) in the Quietly Unseen Loyalists archetype recommend Linear to peers in public while privately feeling ignored, and one review crystallizes the gap between external advocacy and internal invisibility. The unmet need is a recognition pattern that names the people who have carried the product into other teams. Without it, advocacy quietly converts into churn.

A relationship that survives the renewal cycle

Esteem · high confidence · Evidence: Quietly Unseen Loyalists

Thirty-four reviews (63.0%) in the Quietly Unseen Loyalists archetype mention cancellation checklists, October decisions, or uncertainty about next year, and trust is present alongside sadness rather than absent. The unmet need is a relationship that is not re-evaluated at renewal time, so tenure compounds into loyalty instead of fatigue. A price conversation without that relationship reads as a transaction.

Red Flags (30)

Complete set of reviews where the literal wording conflicts with the emotional profile.

Review 1 · 4

positive words negative emotions · Esteem

“The product is fine, I guess. It works.”

Polite 'fine, works' language masks a clearly resigned, low-affect tone with sadness dominant.

Review 2 · 3

positive words negative emotions · Esteem

“Fine. Whatever. It does the job.”

Flat 'fine, whatever' language is disgust and sadness wearing a polite mask.

Review 3 · 3

positive words negative emotions · Esteem

“It's not bad. It just works, I guess.”

Hedged 'not bad' language sits over sadness and low trust.

Review 4 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

“Would be 5 stars if power users had a way to be recognized. We've been here 3 years.”

4-star rating with conditional praise masks sadness and anger about not being recognized.

Review 5 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

“I keep recommending Linear even though support has stopped listening to long-time customers.”

Active recommendation coexists with anger and sadness about being ignored by support.

Review 6 · 4

negative words · positive emotions · Esteem

"We have been paying for seats since 2021 and still feel like a default workspace, not a customer they remember."

Complaint sits on residual trust that keeps the rating at 4.

Review 7 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

"I tell every PM to switch to Linear, then I open my own account and feel ignored."

Strong advocacy sits next to sadness and anger about personal neglect.

Review 8 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

"Three years in and the only badge I have is the invoice. The tool is good. The relationship is not."

Praises tool while explicitly denying the customer relationship — sadness and anger dominate.

Review 9 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

"Saved views and keyboard shortcuts keep me here. Recognition would keep me proud."

Praises features while stating recognition would be needed to feel proud — sadness and anger present.

Review 10 · 4

mixed signals · Belonging

"I still defend Linear in Slack. I wish someone at Linear defended us back."

Loyal advocacy paired with an unfulfilled belonging/esteem need for reciprocal care.

Review 11 · 4

positive words negative emotions · Esteem

“Loyal, tired, and a little embarrassed that 4 stars is the most honest I can be.”

'Loyal' is positive language masking dominant sadness and embarrassment.

Review 12 · 4

mixed signals · Self-actualization

“The UI still feels like it respects us. The roadmap no longer does.”

Praises UI but contrasts it with anger at the roadmap direction.

Review 13 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

“I love it but I probably won't renew.”

Love and renewal refusal coexist — joy/trust versus dominant sadness.

Review 14 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

“I will probably churn at renewal. The product is genuinely good. Those two facts are both true.”

Acknowledges product quality while planning churn — sadness dominates.

Review 17 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

“I love the command menu and I am still pricing Jira Cloud for the team.”

Loves a feature while comparison-shopping a competitor — sadness and low trust present.

Review 18 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

“Cycles made me stay last year. This year I am writing the cancellation checklist.”

Past love and current churn plan coexist — sadness and anger dominate.

Review 19 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

“The product is genuinely excellent and I still opened a Notion trial on Friday.”

High praise coexists with active competitor trial — sadness present.

Review 20 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

“I recommend Linear to friends and I am not sure we will be here in October.”

External advocacy paired with internal departure uncertainty — sadness dominant.

Review 22 · 3

positive words positive emotions · Esteem

“I do not hate Linear. I just cannot justify the renewal to finance.”

'Do not hate' is a soft denial, but anger and sadness still drive the verdict.

Review 33 · 3

mixed signals · Belonging

“Onboarding was lonely. Docs are beautiful and I still had nobody to ask a dumb question.”

'Beautiful docs' praise masks dominant sadness and fear.

Review 34 · 3

mixed signals · Belonging

“New hires wander the workspace like a museum. Gorgeous, empty, no one to sit with.”

'Gorgeous' praise sits beside dominant sadness and isolation.

Review 36 · 3

mixed signals · Belonging

“Templates exist. A human who says here is how we run cycles here does not.”

Notes templates exist yet frames absence of humans as the failure — sadness dominant.

Review 38 · 3

mixed signals · Belonging

“Docs taught me shortcuts. Nobody taught me I was allowed to ask for help.”

Praises docs while exposing deep belonging sadness and fear.

Review 39 · 4

mixed signals · Belonging

“We moved from Jira and the first month felt like coming up for air. Then I realized I had no team channel for Linear questions.”

Initial relief fades into sadness at the absence of a community channel.

Review 40 · 4

mixed signals · Belonging

“I love the product and I eat lunch staring at an empty assignee field.”

'Love' sits beside dominant sadness and isolation at lunch.

Review 42 · 3

mixed signals · Belonging

“Mentions feel like shouting into a well. Beautiful well. Still a well.”

Aesthetic praise ('beautiful well') sits over dominant sadness and anger.

Review 51 · 4

mixed signals · Self-actualization

“Great bones. I wish it did more for people who have been around for years.”

'Great bones' praise sits beside sadness and anger at neglected tenure.

Review 52 · 4

mixed signals · Self-actualization

“Custom workflows for mature teams still feel like we are pretending to be a startup.”

4-star rating contrasts with sadness, disgust, and anger about maturity gap.

Review 53 · 4

mixed signals · Self-actualization

“I want Linear to grow with us, not freeze the product the month we got good at it.”

Praises past growth but fear, sadness, and anger about frozen roadmap.

Review 54 · 4

mixed signals · Self-actualization

“Automation is close. Mastery is not. I keep hitting a ceiling that looks like a blank settings page.”

Notes near-mastery yet frames the ceiling with sadness and anger.

Recommendations (4)

The complete set of recommendations generated after human approval.

Recovery they can verify on their own

high priority · Effort L

Ship a self-serve restore workflow that lets any workspace admin run a dry-run restore against a read-only sandbox, with a per-entity diff and a verifiable checksum signature, so customers can prove recoverability without trusting marketing copy.

Visible presence during incidents

high priority · Effort L

Launch a real-time incident channel that pages a named Linear engineer into the affected workspace during incidents, with a postmortem that lands in the same workspace within 48 hours, so trust repairs inside the customer's environment instead of on a public status page.

Recognition of quiet evangelism

medium priority · Effort M

Ship a tenure-aware member badge and a referrer recognition program that surfaces advocates inside Linear (cycles, mentions) so that the people carrying the product into other teams are visible to the company and to their peers.

A relationship that survives the renewal cycle

high priority · Effort M

Replace the renewal transaction with a tenure check-in program: a named account partner reaches out 90 days before renewal with a workspace health review, and pricing changes are framed as tenure milestones rather than line items.

Linear: what customers are really saying

A concise synthesis of the complete Resonance analysis.

Across 54 analyzed reviews, the primary emotional driver is sadness. Resonance identified 3 customer segments, 4 unspoken needs, and 30 cognitive-dissonance red flags.

PRIORITY 1

Recovery they can verify on their own

Ship a self-serve restore workflow that lets any workspace admin run a dry-run restore against a read-only sandbox, with a per-entity diff and a verifiable checksum signature, so customers can prove recoverability without trusting marketing copy.

PRIORITY 2

Visible presence during incidents

Launch a real-time incident channel that pages a named Linear engineer into the affected workspace during incidents, with a postmortem that lands in the same workspace within 48 hours, so trust repairs inside the customer's environment instead of on a public status page.

PRIORITY 3

Recognition of quiet evangelism

Ship a tenure-aware member badge and a referrer recognition program that surfaces advocates inside Linear (cycles, mentions) so that the people carrying the product into other teams are visible to the company and to their peers.